

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Outbreak Signals Before Alarm

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C21
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Detect possible outbreaks through governed baselines, thresholds, persistence, corroboration, uncertainty, and authorized public-health escalation.

Why it matters

Premature alarms can cause panic, while delayed escalation can allow a genuine outbreak to spread.

Illustrative application

A syndromic signal exceeding a seasonal baseline is corroborated across facilities before epidemiological review.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.